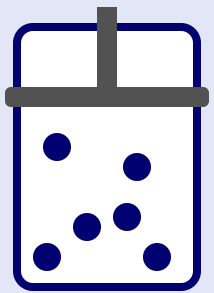
What do the numbers 1 and 2 mean in the gas laws?

STATE 1 = BEFORE

the gas at the beginning



p_1 V_1 T_1

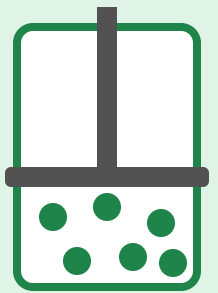
a change

we heat it, cool it, compress it or let it expand

→

STATE 2 = AFTER

the gas at the end, after the change



p_2 V_2 T_2

1

= **initial** value (before the change)

2

= **final** value (after the change)

It is the **same gas**: the small number only tells us **when** we measure it.